

ABIRAMI S V – INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY

Intern + FTE in SecureW2

About the company

SecureW2 is a SaaS Cybersecurity company pioneering the development of certificate-driven enterprise security. It specializes in passwordless security for wired, wireless, VPN, and ZTNA, and application security, ensuring an organization is protected from credential and data theft. Their clientele ranges from Peloton, STMicroelectronics, The Pokemon Company, Glassdoor, American Red Cross, Freshworks, Harvard University, and many other organizations across the globe.

About the role

Role: Software Developer

A Software Developer is responsible for the design, development and maintenance of web applications and websites. Would work on both front end and back-end development as full stack developer. Responsibilities include coding, designing UIs, collaborating with stakeholders, testing applications, troubleshooting problems, maintaining applications, documenting code and research.

Overview of the process

- Round 1 – Online Coding Test (in CUIC)
- Round 2 – Technical Interview 1 (in CUIC)
- Round 3 – Written Coding Test (in SecureW2 Office)
- Round 4 – Technical Interview 2 (in SecureW2 Office)

ONLINE CODING TEST

The online coding test consisted of 5 questions divided into 2 sections: 3 easy questions and 2 hard questions. The easy section focused on basic array problems, while the hard section had dynamic programming problems. The test duration was 2 hours.

Results were announced immediately after the test and interviews for shortlisted students were conducted shortly thereafter.

TECHNICAL INTERVIEW 1

This round was mainly based on my resume. The interviewer asked me detailed questions about the projects I had worked on including why I chose certain technologies over others and the challenges faced. He also asked some basic questions about Spring Boot and AngularJS.

Then I was asked to explain the logic for simple problems like binary search. The interviewer was happy with my answers and asked if I had any other job offers and if I would accept the job if selected. The interview ended on a good note.

The results were announced the next day and the shortlisted students were invited to the SecureW2 office for the further rounds.

WRITTEN CODING TEST

The test included 4 questions and we were asked to write the code on paper in our preferred programming language. One question involved finding the absolute difference between the sums of the primary and secondary diagonal elements in an $N \times N$ matrix. Another was to find all substrings of a given string and count the number of pairs that are anagrams. The remaining two questions were situation-based problems that could be solved using arrays. The test duration was 1 hour.

The results were announced after 2 hours and the technical interviews for shortlisted students were conducted immediately after.

TECHNICAL INTERVIEW 2

The interview was conducted by the company director and the head of the development team. It began with the usual 'Tell me about yourself'. Many questions were asked about Java, including multithreading, collections, how ArrayLists work internally and whether I thought Java was better than other programming languages, along with a justification.

Next, we moved on to DBMS, where I was asked about normalization and cursors. They also asked about my knowledge of the company (make sure to research the company before an interview!). Since it is a security company, I was asked some security-related questions, mainly about certificates, HTTPS, and SSL/TLS.

Towards the end, they asked about my interview preparation strategy, my location preferences, and my feedback on the recruitment process. Although I couldn't answer a few questions, the interviewers were understanding and the interview ended on a positive note.

Finally, 5 students received the offer and the offer letters were given on spot.

General Tips

- Stay consistent in your DSA preparation.
- Be confident during interviews. It's alright if you don't know some answers. The focus is mainly on how well you can explain what you know and your willingness to learn what you don't know yet.

- Research the company, its products, and clients. Have basic knowledge of the company's domain (eg: security in this case).
- Be strong in the basics of DSA, OOPS, DBMS, OS, Networks.
- Be confident about everything you've mentioned in your resume.
- Most importantly, don't lose hope! Facing rejections and seeing everyone around you get placed isn't easy, but trust the process and keep putting in the effort.

ALL THE BEST!!

PS: Everyone at the company was super friendly and approachable. They even offered us refreshments and lunch. Overall, it was a good experience.